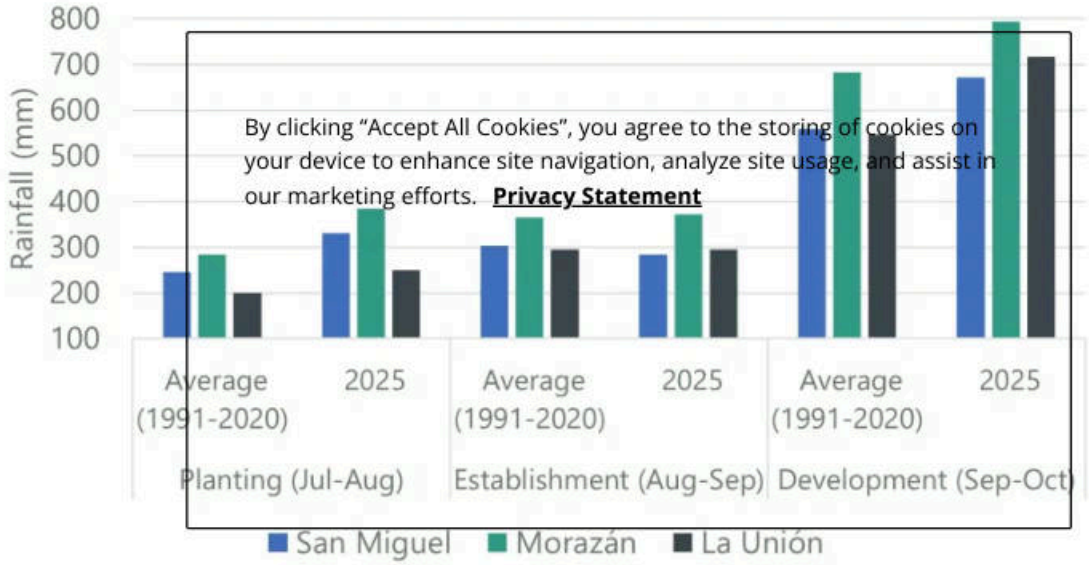
Figure 1

Rainfall during postrera crop stages across the eastern Dry Corridor, 2025



Source: USGS, FEWS NET, Climate Hazards Center at University of California-Santa Barbara

Erratic rainfall distribution throughout the 2025 crop calendar disrupted crop establishment and development stages for both main agricultural cycles, leading to below-average yields and reduced household food stocks for some poor households. Below-average rainfall at planting affected initial *primera* crop conditions, but improved moisture during *primera* development stages supported near-average maize production overall. However, the *postrera* cycle was particularly irregular, with excess moisture during critical bean development stages that negatively impacted smallholder farmers, mainly in the eastern Dry Corridor (Figure 1). Although rainfall during the August *postrera* planting period was near average, September and October brought sustained heavy precipitation during crop development, when beans are highly sensitive to prolonged wet conditions. This was followed by a sharp decline in rainfall by mid-November that caused additional localized crop stress. Below-average *postrera* yields resulted in below-average household food stocks; by early 2026, affected poor rural households have depleted food stocks earlier-than-typical and are atypically reliant on markets to access food.

Figure 2

White maize wholesale prices change across key eastern markets, January 2026

